QUICK GUIDE

MIDRANGE VOCAL SEPARATION

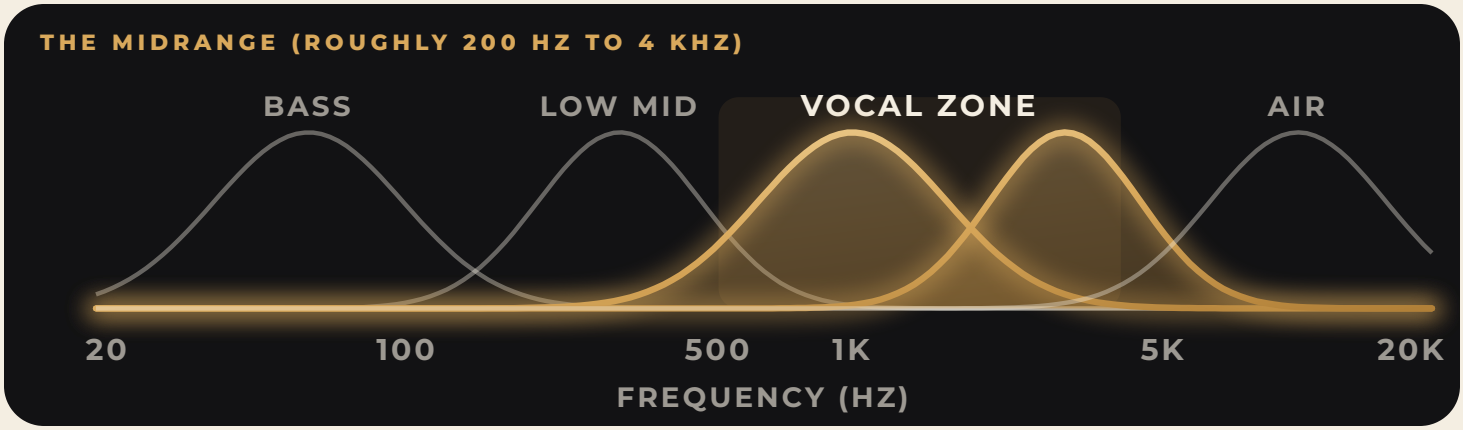
What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

WHAT IT IS

The midrange is the part of the spectrum, roughly 200 Hz to 4 kHz, where vocals, guitars, synths and snares all live. Vocal separation means making room there so the voice stays clear.

HOW IT SOUNDS

Clear and forward when it's right. Boxy, muddy or buried when it isn't.



01

LOW MIDS ADD BODY

Roughly 200 to 500 Hz. Too much sounds boxy or muddy.

02

MIDS CARRY THE VOCAL

Roughly 500 Hz to 2 kHz. This is where the words live.

03

UPPER MIDS ADD CLARITY

Roughly 2 to 4 kHz. A small boost brings presence.

DO THIS TONIGHT

Cut the competing mids on the other track before you boost the vocal.

- [ ] Find the vocal range, about 500 Hz to 4 kHz.
- [ ] Turn the mid knob down a little on the other track.
- [ ] Still hidden? Add a touch of mids to the vocal. Small moves only.



PRACTICE & CHECK

MIDRANGE VOCAL SEPARATION: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Mixing an acapella over an instrumental.
- Blending two full tracks without the vocals clashing.
- Fixing a vocal that disappears when the drums come in.

QUICK CHECK

1. Roughly where does the midrange sit?

2. What do you cut first when vocals clash?

3. What does too much low-mid sound like?

Answer key: 1) About 200 Hz to 4 kHz. 2) The competing mids on the other track. 3) Boxy or muddy.

REMEMBER

Make room first. Boost second.

YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Resonance Control

